

Android App testing gets easier with TestFairy

Test Fairy

With all the new ranges of smartphones and tabs, touch screen technology is hitting an all-time high. In this intense war game, considering its market share, Android can easily be called the clear winner. Despite all this, fragmentation is a persistent problem at the consumer end, and as Google is aware of this problem, it has rolled out some solutions.

But why does the fragmentation occur in the first place? Well, fragmentation takes place when an Android app is tested in multiple environments by using 'the Crowd'. Consider this. If you send the APK (installation file, such as exe in Windows) to your friend, who has a Galaxy S4 mobile and to your brother who has an S3, each would come up with his own feedback about how it worked on his mobile.

Here's where the TestFairy comes in. It is an Android app that offers an amazing platform to reduce the hassles for developers. It helps developers to send APK (the extension file for Android) with an integrated monitoring technology. TestFairy will record a user's experience and show you exactly how he/she behaved. The app will also provide you with a video showing details pertaining to the battery usage of the app, CPU and memory usage, network connectivity, etc. After the app is installed on the user's phone, TestFairy offers proper feedback to the developer. A developer need not code at all, but can just upload the SDK file to TestFairy and specify the e-mail addresses of the testers whom you want the app to be distributed to. Then, all you need to do is wait for the result.

Linux Mint 15 'Olivia' released

Linux enthusiasts who have got past Fedora and OpenSUSE, can now sit up and take notice of the latest Linux Mint 15 'Olivia'. Debian-based Linux distributions have come a long way and are doing very well, currently. With Linux Mint 15, users get to choose between the Cinnamon or MATE desktop offerings. Both options essentially do the same task, though Cinnamon is clearly the popular choice.

This latest Olivia release is the first of the two annual releases that the company has planned for 2013. It is definitely a renewed approach that the developers have taken, compared to last November's release.

The first thing that you notice is the new version of Cinnamon—Cinnamon 1.8. There are a number of bug fixes and you can no longer control it through GNOME, which was the predecessor to both Cinnamon and MATE.

In addition, the login screen can be customised through HTML5, making it pretty advanced in comparison to other operating systems. Users can now create their own login screens and add animation too.

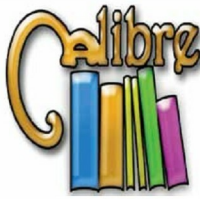


Open source management product, Calibre, converts MS Office files

Calibre, the well-known open source management product, is now capable of converting Docx files, which is the default file format for Microsoft Word ever since Office 2007 Suite was introduced. Calibre's latest release 0.9.34 is the first version of the program to come with the option to convert the common Word document files.

The convert option also offers support to lists, tables, images, text formatting, footnotes, endnotes, and drop capitals at the beginning of text blocks. The Calibre developers have released a sample video showing how the convert works; however, users must be aware that the code is still new and may contain bugs.

Along with the convert option, Calibre gets a new driver for Kobo reader's recently released firmware version 2.6.1. Calibre's e-book preview now offers users the option to navigate back and forward via the Alt+Left and Alt+Right keyboard shortcuts.



LynuxWorks announces LynxOS 7.0 with new security features

LynuxWorks Inc, a world leader in the embedded software market, recently announced LynxOS 7.0, the next generation of its most popular real-time operating system (RTOS), which enables embedded developers to add security functionality to their connected devices. The open standards-based LynxOS has been powering millions of embedded devices for the last 25 years across all industries and now adds significant new features to help meet the needs of the billions of next-generation connected devices.